

# Utku Dagli, MSc

Game and Technical Designer

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## Professional Summary

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Multidisciplinary Game and Technical Designer with over 7 years of experience across studio, research and teaching roles, including nearly 2 years in professional development roles. Skilled in designing, prototyping and implementing gameplay systems, progression mechanics, and AI characters for PC and VR/AR. Combines a Computer Engineering foundation with a Master's in Game Studies and Engineering, with one published PC project. Proficient with Unreal Engine, Unity, C++, C#, and Lua, with a strong record of cross-disciplinary collaboration and player-centred design.

## Core Skills

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**Game & Technical Design:** System Design, Progression Design, AI Design, Level Design, Game Design Documentation, Playtesting, Player-Centred Design.

**UX & Research:** UX Design, User Research, Usability Testing, Analytics.

**Programming:** C++, C#, Unreal Engine Blueprint, Lua, Python.

**Engines & Tools:** Unreal Engine 4/5, Unity, Blender, Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Git, SVN, Perforce, Jira, Confluence.

## Professional Experience

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**Game Designer** | Axiosys (Remote) | November 2025 – *Present*

- Designed and prototyped progression, traversal, and exploration mechanics, ecosystem behaviour and AI characters for Mawforged, a dark-fantasy survival game.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and maintain sustainable, scalable gameplay systems aligned with team standards.
- Produced design documentation and iterated on systems based on internal feedback and playtesting.

**Tutor – Game Studies and Engineering** | University of Klagenfurt, Austria | August 2021 – July 2023

- Designed and delivered educational sessions on game design, mechanics, and user experience to graduate-level students.
- Collaborated with academic staff and multidisciplinary teams to enhance learning outcomes and student engagement.
- Mentored students on practical game development projects, providing feedback on design and implementation.

**Junior Frontend Developer** | Adesso Turkey, Istanbul | August 2020 – February 2021

- Developed client-side applications in Angular/TypeScript within a professional software house, applying component-based architecture and front-end engineering practices.

**Junior Gameplay Developer / Designer** | HES Games, Istanbul | June 2020 – August 2020

- Contributed as a multifaceted developer in a small team, building core gameplay features in Unreal Engine for Sabotaj, a competitive FPS game shipped on Steam.
- Shaped game design and UX elements collaboratively, increasing user engagement through iterative testing and design reviews.

- Designed and implemented gameplay and UI/UX features, working closely with art and design disciplines.

### **Junior Game Developer** | GarageAtlas, Istanbul | June 2019 – March 2020

- Initiated and led the implementation of core features for Oculus Quest and HTC Vive headsets, including VR Crane, Atlas Home, Atlas Space and B2B client work.
- Optimised performance and immersion for standalone VR hardware.
- Developed multiplayer functionality and interaction mechanics from early prototype through to production.

## **Education**

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### **MSc, Game Studies and Engineering** | 2020 – 2024

University of Klagenfurt, Austria

*Master's Thesis: Punishment Mechanics in Video Games: Effects on Player Experience and Flow.*

### **BSc, Computer Engineering** | 2014 – 2019

Kadir Has University, Istanbul

## **Certifications**

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Google UX Design Professional Certificate – Coursera (Credential: [coursera.org/verify/professional-cert/6RYKVJ62CSCG](https://coursera.org/verify/professional-cert/6RYKVJ62CSCG))

## **Publications**

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**Punishment Mechanics in Video Games: Effects on Player Experience and Flow** – Master's Thesis, University of Klagenfurt (2024). Available at: [resolver.obvsg.at/urn:nbn:at:at-ubk:1-54367](https://resolver.obvsg.at/urn:nbn:at:at-ubk:1-54367)

**The Difficulty of Videogames and Intelligence of AI** – Play/Write Student Journal, Vol. II (May 2022). DOI: [10.48415/001.2022.02.5](https://doi.org/10.48415/001.2022.02.5)

## **Notable Projects**

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**Mawforged** – Dark-fantasy survival game for PC. In development on Unreal Engine 5, planned for release on [Steam](https://store.steampowered.com/app/1673270/Mawforged/). Worked as a Game Designer

**Heretic** – Roguelike for PC. Solo project developed on Unreal Engine 5 and shared on [itch.io](https://itch.io) as a prototype, applying master's thesis research on punishment mechanics. Designed and implemented gameplay systems, AI behaviours and attack patterns, and mechanics/stat balancing.

**Sabotaj** – Competitive FPS game for PC. Developed on Unreal Engine 4 and published on [Steam](https://store.steampowered.com/app/1673270/Sabotaj/). Designed and implemented gameplay modes and UI/UX; contributed to development and gameplay design.

**Atlas Space** – VR experiences for standalone and tethered Headsets. Developed on Unreal Engine 4 for cross-platform PC and VR. Delivered early prototypes, multiplayer functionality, and core interaction mechanics.

**VR Crane & Atlas Home** – VR porting experience for standalone and tethered Headsets. Developed on Unreal Engine 4. Designed and developed as B2B work, later used in a studio showcase. Worked on optimising performance across VR headsets.

**D.o.E.P (Doors of Endless Possibilities)** – 2D top-down adventure game for the 4th Klagenfurt Winter Game Jam. Developed on Unity, shared on [itch.io](https://itch.io). Worked on the user interface and core game mechanics.

## **Languages**

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Turkish (Native) | English (C1) | German (A2)